

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE  
2 BILL NO. 1770

By: Moore of the House

3 and

4 Murdock of the Senate  
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7 An Act relating to animals; enacting the Elk  
8 Population Study and Management Act; defining terms;  
9 requiring certain organizations to establish a plan  
10 and outline for a comprehensive study of the elk  
11 population within a certain region of the state;  
12 requiring the plan and outline to be completed on a  
13 certain date; providing requirements for the  
14 comprehensive study; providing for coordination with  
15 other relevant state and federal agencies; requiring  
16 the maintenance of detailed accounting and financial  
17 records of appropriations received and expenditures  
18 made; providing that external experts and scientists  
19 may be engaged to complete the study; providing for  
20 codification; providing an effective date; and  
21 declaring an emergency.

22 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

23 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified  
24 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 4101 of Title 2, unless there is  
created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

A. This act shall be known and may be cited as the "Elk  
Population Study and Management Act".

B. As used in this act:

1        1. "Authority" refers to the Oklahoma State University  
2 Veterinary Medicine Authority;

3        2. "Management plan" refers to a document developed based on  
4 the findings of the study that outlines recommended actions for the  
5 conservation and management of elk populations; and

6        3. "Study zone" refers to the Special Northwest Zone that  
7 encompasses all private lands in Woodward, Dewey, and Ellis  
8 Counties, and a portion of Roger Mills County north of State  
9 Highways 33 and 47 to the north county line and west to the state  
10 border and east to the county line.

11        C. No later than November 1, 2026, the Oklahoma State  
12 University Veterinary Medicine Authority, in cooperation with the  
13 OSU College of Veterinary Medicine, shall establish a plan and  
14 outline for a comprehensive study of the elk population within the  
15 Special Northwest Zone. The comprehensive study shall assess  
16 current population levels, trends, and habitat usage, and develop  
17 science-based management recommendations aimed at ensuring the long-  
18 term sustainability of elk populations and the health of the  
19 ecosystem. The comprehensive study shall include, but not be  
20 limited to, the following program characteristics:

21        1. The current elk population size, distribution, and density  
22 within the study zone;  
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1        2. The health and genetic diversity of the elk population,  
2 including disease monitoring and signs of inbreeding or other health  
3 concerns;

4        3. The effectiveness and impact of current elk population  
5 management strategies, including hunting, predation control, and  
6 habitat conservation; and

7        4. Recommendations culminating in the form of a management plan  
8 for the conservation and management of elk populations within the  
9 study zone.

10       D. The Authority may coordinate with other relevant state and  
11 federal agencies to effectuate the provisions of this act. Such  
12 coordination may include requests for temporary suspension and/or  
13 restrictions of elk hunting or harvesting while the comprehensive  
14 study is being conducted.

15       E. The Authority shall maintain detailed accounting and  
16 financial records of appropriations received and expenditures made  
17 pursuant to the purposes of this act. The Authority may engage  
18 external experts and scientists to plan and implement the  
19 comprehensive study. The engagement of such external experts shall  
20 be implemented in accordance with the policies of the Authority.  
21 The Authority is authorized to carry forward to a future fiscal year  
22 any unexpended funds related to this act.

23       SECTION 2. This act shall become effective July 1, 2026.  
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SECTION 3. It being immediately necessary for the preservation of the public peace, health or safety, an emergency is hereby declared to exist, by reason whereof this act shall take effect and be in full force from and after its passage and approval.

Passed the House of Representatives the 11th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House  
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the \_\_\_\_\_ day of \_\_\_\_\_, 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the Senate